

Looking after your shop — a little guide

Hi Jie! This is everything you need to run your website day to day. You don't need to touch any code, and nothing here can break the site, so feel free to potter about and try things. If anything ever looks off, it can always be undone.

Grab a cuppa and have a read. It's shorter than it looks.

The big picture (how it all fits together)

Think of it as two parts that talk to each other:

1. **Your Google Sheet** — this is your control panel. It's where all your products live: their names, prices, photos, what's in stock, and so on.
2. **Your website** — this reads your sheet and shows everything off beautifully.

When you change something in the sheet, the website picks it up on its own within a minute or two. No buttons to press, no "publish", nothing technical. You edit the sheet, the site updates. That's the whole trick.

The only thing that works a little differently is **adding a brand-new photo**, which has one extra step. More on that further down.

Your Google Sheet (your control panel)

Open your sheet (`littlecrafts_products`). You'll see two tabs along the bottom:

- **Products** — one row per item in your shop.
- **settings** — a tiny tab with one job: opening and closing commissions.

The Products tab, column by column

Each product is one row. Here's what each column does:

Column	What to put	Example
name	The product's name as you want it shown	heart keychain – red
price	Just the number, no pound sign	6
category	One of three words (see below)	all-time
in_stock	yes or no	yes
photo_url	The photo's file name	crochet-heart-keychain-red.png
description	A friendly sentence about the make	a little crocheted heart in cherry red...

A few gentle rules so things look right:

- **price** is a number only. The website adds the £ for you, so just type 6 , not £6 .
- **in_stock** must be yes or no . Anything else and the site treats it as sold out to be safe.
- **description** is optional. Leave it blank and the site shows a soft default line. But a personal sentence always reads lovelier.
- Don't rename or reorder the column headers in row 1. The site looks for them by name.

The three categories (what they mean)

The category word decides which filter tab a product shows under on your shop page. You have three to choose from:

- all-time — your regulars, the things you usually keep making (bags, keychains).
- limited — seasonal or small-batch makes (leg warmers, pouches).
- one-time — proper one-offs you don't plan to repeat (like the star jar).

On the shop page these appear as tabs: all, all-time, limited, one-time, so a visitor can browse by type. Pick whichever fits. If you're unsure, all-time is a safe default.

Adding a new product (step by step)

Two small jobs: pop the photo into the website's folder, then add the row in your sheet.

Step 1 — upload the photo

1. Go to github.com and open your shop's repository.
2. Click into the public folder, then the products folder.
3. Click Add file → Upload files.
4. Drag your photo in (a .png or .jpg is perfect).
5. Scroll down and click Commit changes.

That's it. The website quietly rebuilds itself with the new photo in about a minute or two. You can watch it happen on the Actions tab if you're curious, but you don't have to.

Tip for photo names: keep them all lower-case with hyphens instead of spaces, like lavender-pouch.png . It saves a lot of little headaches later.

Step 2 — add the row in your sheet

1. Open the Products tab.
2. Add a new row at the bottom.
3. Fill in each column (name, price, category, in_stock, description).
4. In photo_url, type the exact file name you just uploaded, e.g. lavender-pouch.png .

Refresh your website after a minute and your new make is there. Done!

Important: the file name in the sheet must match the uploaded file **exactly**, capital letters and all. This is why the all-lower-case-with-hyphens habit helps.

Everyday tweaks (the easy stuff)

These all update from the sheet alone. No photo upload, no waiting around beyond a minute or two:

- **Mark something sold out:** change its `in_stock` from `yes` to `no`. The site adds a "sold out" badge and gently fades the photo.
- **Back in stock:** change it back to `yes`.
- **Change a price:** just edit the number in `price`.
- **Rename a product or tweak a description:** edit the `name` or `description` cell.
- **Hide a product completely:** delete its row (or keep the row somewhere safe lower down and remove the `photo_url` if you'd rather not lose the text).

Edit, wait a moment, refresh. That's the rhythm for everything.

Opening and closing commissions

This lives on the `settings` tab. There's a single cell that matters:

- Type `yes` under `commissions_open` when you're taking commissions.
- Type `no` when you're closed or have a backlog.

The website updates its commissions banner to match. One word, that's all.

How orders and payment work

Your site doesn't take payment itself, on purpose, so there's nothing financial to manage on it. It points people to your existing forms:

- **Orders / commissions** go through your **Google Form**.
- **Payment** is handled through your separate **payment form** (PayPal / Ko-fi / bank).

So a customer browses the shop, clicks through to your form, and you carry on exactly how you do now. The website is your shop window; the forms are your till.

The Size Guide page

There's a **Size Guide** page with a drawn diagram of your measurements. You don't need to type sizes into each product, it's all on that one page, which keeps your sheet tidy. If you ever change your standard sizes and want the diagram updated, just give a shout and it can be swapped out.

"How long until my change shows up?"

- **Sheet edits** (price, stock, name, description, opening commissions): usually under a minute or two. Google holds the data briefly, so if you don't see it right away, give it a couple of minutes and refresh the page (on a keyboard, **Ctrl + F5** forces a fresh load).
- **A new photo upload:** a minute or two for the site to rebuild, then it's there.

If something hasn't appeared after five minutes, a refresh almost always sorts it.

A few golden rules (to keep things safe and happy)

- **Keep private things private.** Only your **Products** and **settings** tabs are connected to the public site. Never put customer details, addresses, or order notes in those two tabs. If you want to track that sort of thing, use a **separate** sheet.
 - **Google Drive links won't work for photos.** Drive blocks photos from showing on other websites, so always upload to the **products** folder as described above.
 - **Two-factor login is your friend.** Keep it switched on for both your GitHub and Google accounts. It's the main thing keeping your site and shop yours.
 - **Nothing you do in the sheet can break the website.** Worst case, a typo means one product looks odd until you fix the cell. Breathe easy and experiment.
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If you ever get stuck

If a photo won't show, it's almost always one of three things:

1. The file name in the sheet doesn't **exactly** match the uploaded file (check the capitals and the **.png** / **.jpg** ending).
2. The photo hasn't finished uploading yet, give it a minute.
3. A simple typo in the **photo_url** cell.

And if anything bigger ever looks wrong, don't worry about fixing the code yourself, just reach out and it can be sorted.

That's everything. Enjoy your shop, Jie. It's lovely. 🧡